

Childhelp Tennessee — August 2026 Digital Advertising Summary

Reporting period: August 1 – August 31, 2026

A Deliberate Change of Approach

August was the month we stopped buying reach and started buying attention. Through the first half of the year the display campaign had been scaling up — more impressions, more people seeing the message. In August we did the opposite on purpose: we cut display volume by roughly a third and concentrated the spend on the audiences and placements that had been responding best. The result was the clearest efficiency gain of the year.

The Month in Numbers

- Display click-through rate: **2.42%** — up from 1.53% in July, and the strongest of 2026
- Display clicks: **1,297** (up from 1,211) on **53,623** impressions (down from 79,092)
- Search click-through rate: **7.25%** on 1,807 impressions and 131 clicks
- Phone taps from ad visitors: **16** (July 17)
- Form clicks from ad visitors: **1** — the first reading after three blank months
- Tennessee section visitors: **286** across **398** page views

Fewer People Saw the Ads. More People Clicked Them.

This is the trade every campaign hopes to make. Click-through rate is simply the share of people who see an ad and then act on it. In July, roughly 15 people in every thousand who saw a display ad clicked it. In August that number was 24. Getting more total clicks out of a third fewer impressions means the message is now reaching people who actually want it, rather than being spread thin across an audience that was never going to respond.

For context, display advertising in the nonprofit space typically runs between 0.5% and 1.0%. August's 2.42% is well over double the top of that range.

Search held its ground. The search campaign delivered 1,807 impressions and 131 clicks at a 7.25% click-through rate. That's a step down from July's unusually strong 8.01%, but July was an outlier month — 7.25% still sits comfortably above the 4–6% range typical for nonprofit search advertising. Reach was essentially identical month to month.

One ad group stood out. "Become Foster Parent" — the smallest group in the search campaign at 185 impressions — returned a **10.27%** click-through rate, the highest of the four. It's the most direct, most decided phrasing in the set, and the people searching it are the furthest along in their thinking. Small volume, but the highest-quality traffic in the account.

The Form Tracking Question — Answered

In July's report we flagged that form-click tracking hadn't been registering and that we were verifying the measurement. **It is now working.** August recorded its first form click from an ad visitor. The number itself is small — one — but the important part is that the measurement path is confirmed live rather than broken. From here the figure will move with real activity, and we'll be able to show form interest alongside phone interest each month.

Where the Interest Came From

Knoxville continued to supply the overwhelming majority of display reach at 44,057 impressions, with Farragut (3,696), Karns (2,321) and Powell (1,631) filling in around it. The display audience split almost exactly evenly between women and men this month, and skewed older than in July — the 55–64 and 35–44 brackets together accounted for about two-thirds of impressions.

On the search side, Knoxville again led with 1,370 impressions. Notably, when we look at the wider website, Knoxville visitors viewed 6.59 pages per visit — the highest engagement of any city in the data, and a useful signal that local interest runs deeper than raw visitor counts suggest.

Traffic Volumes Followed the Spend

With display impressions reduced by a third, the number of people arriving on the site from ads came down as well — 234 unique ad-attributable visitors in August, and 286 visitors to the Tennessee section. July was a high-water mark on both measures, helped by the larger display buy. This is the expected consequence of a deliberate volume reduction rather than a change in underlying interest, and it's the reason we watch click-through rate and phone taps alongside visitor counts: phone taps held at 16 against July's 17, on a considerably smaller audience.

Where This Points

August proved that the campaign can get better results from less exposure. Now that we know which audiences carry the response, the sensible next step is to rebuild volume gradually on the stronger side of the mix rather than across the board — and to watch whether phone taps and form clicks hold their level as reach comes back up. Fall tends to be a steadier period for this kind of recruitment message than mid-summer, which should work in the campaign's favor over the next two months.

Prepared by Dickson Media & Events